There are three membranes inclosing the brain. The external is a strong, firm tissue, lining the cranial cavity, and adhering closely to the bones; it also dips down between the two hemispheres, and, being reflected back over either side, forms the double fold which divides them. This membrane is called the *dura mater*, or "hard mother," from the belief of the old anatomists that it originated all the strong membranes of the body.

The second membrane is called the *arachnoid*, or "spider-web," from its exceeding attenuation. This membrane dips into all the convolutions, and upon its surface is spread out the extensive vascular system which supplies the brain with blood.

The third and inner membrane is an exceedingly fine and delicate investiture which incloses all the brain-matter, and is termed *pia mater*, or "soft mother," in contradistinction to the dura mater.

Myriads of minute vessels are spread out between these membranes, besides which there is a serous fluid secreted by the arachnoid, serving the same lubricating purpose as that effected by the serous sacs which inclose the heart, lungs, and other internal organs. All these membranes, in the same order as they exist in the cranium, form the tubular sheath which invests the spinal cord.

The cerebellum, or back brain, is situated at the base of the cerebrum, or front brain, and is in part covered by it. In structure, as in functions, it differs from the cerebrum, its surface being furrowed with lines or ridges instead of convolutions. Like the cerebrum, it is divided into two hemispheres, sepa-